Capstone Presentation

GRADUATE EXPERIENCE

Graduate Assistant

- Developing and planning programing to support co-curricular learning outcomes.
- Coordinating assessment activities.
- Supporting leadership development (HSOC /HLC Fellows)

Practicum

- Student- Athletes Services
- Residence Life
- Office of Academic Advising and Planning

PROFESSIONAL COMPETENCIES

Foundational

- Values, Philosophy, and History
- Law, Policy, and Governance
- Organizational and Human Resource

Proficient

- Assessment, Evaluation, and Research
- Personal and Ethical Foundations
- Student Learning and Development

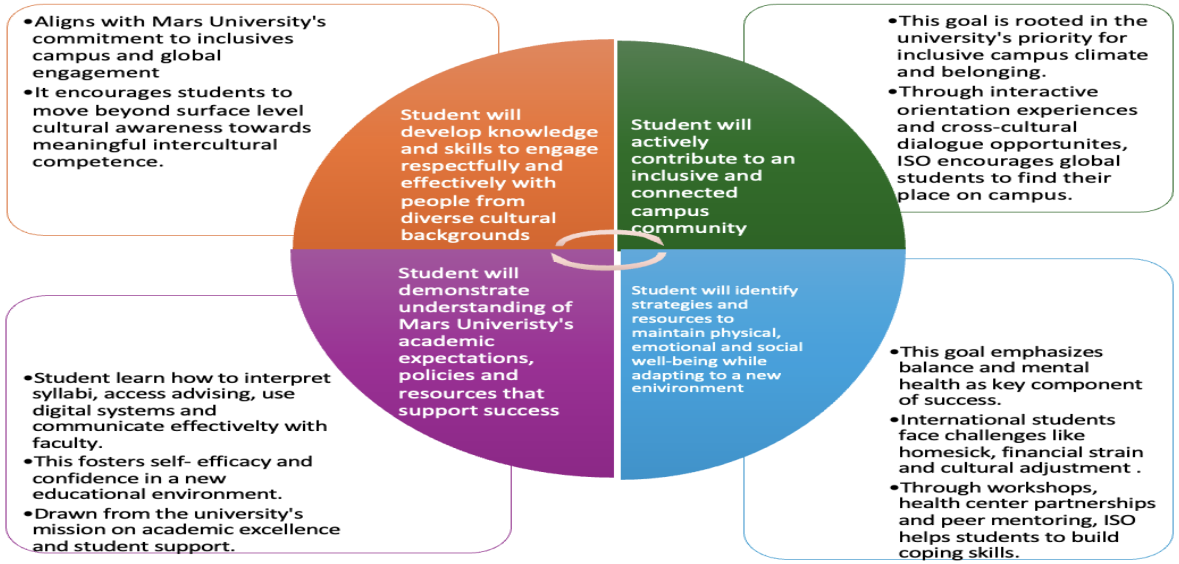


Fig. 1. Learning Goals and Narrative Justification of the International Student Orientation for Mars University by Mensah (2025).

CSP 6040: deepening understanding of curricular approaches, outcome-aligned design, and institutional mission alignment

exemplary.

Advising and Supporting

Advised a caseload of 29 undecided Bachelor of Science students at the Office of Academic Advising and Planning (Fall 2025)

Social Justice and Inclusion

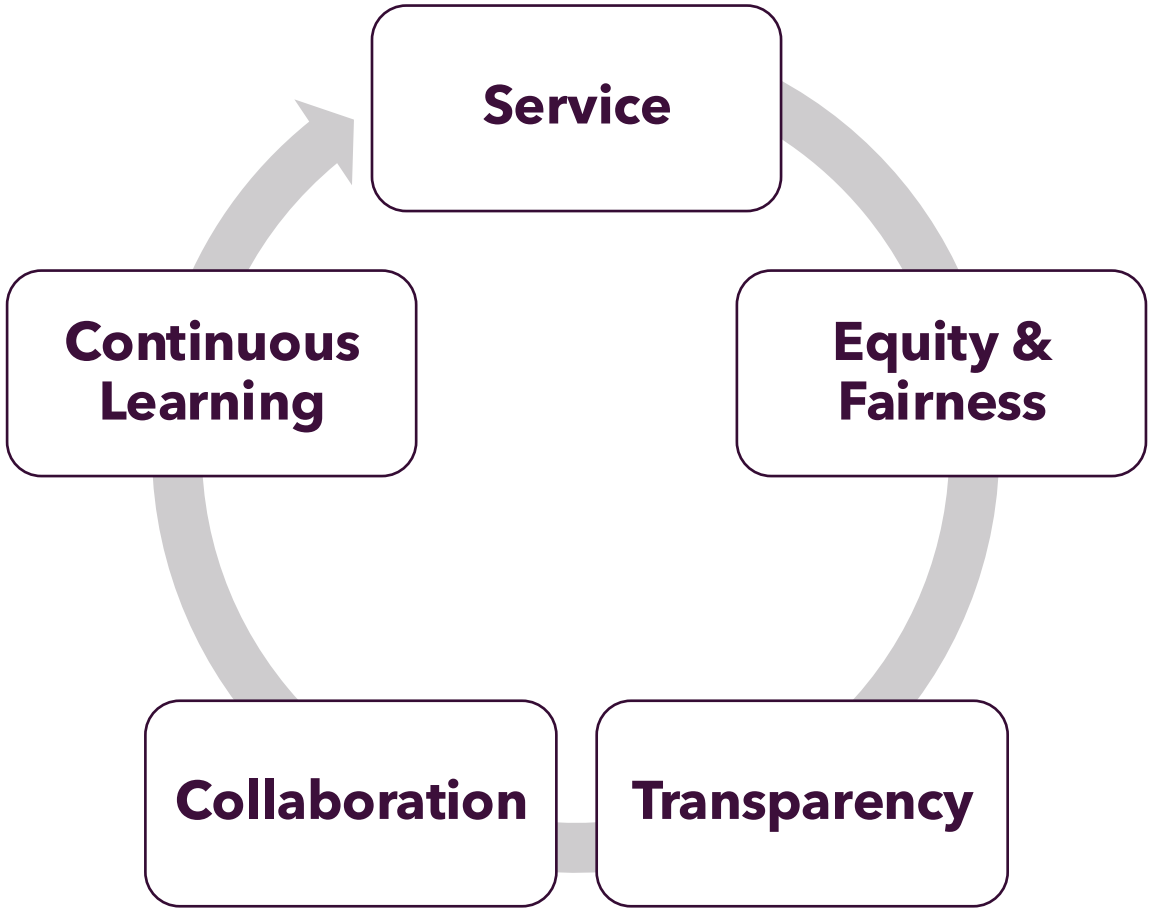
Conducted a scholarly equity audit of BGSU's mandatory health insurance policy in CSP 6035, documenting structural barriers disproportionately burdening international students

Leadership

Coordinating and Supervising Community Meals on financial literacy, time management, professional development, and interview preparation.

Advising Philiosophy

PROFESSIONAL VALUES



To empower diverse students towards autonomy and self-discovery through empathetic guidance, deep relationships, and collaborative community. Grounded in accountability, integrity, and faith, I champion equity, fairness, and continuous learning, walking alongside each students from transition to purpose and serving the evolving educational landscape with unwavering dedication.

CURRENT ISSUE

What Gets Measured, What Gets Missed

Student Engagement & Assessment

ISSUE

Engagement Problem

- Institutions equate engagement with visibility attendance, titles, vocal participation
- Students who engage quietly, relationally, or digitally are invisible to these systems

Assessment Problem

- The tools we use to measure engagement are built around Sign-in sheets, co-curricular transcripts, satisfaction surveys.
- These measure what students visibly do, not what they experience, feel, learn, or whether they belong.

Why This Issue Matters

- **Retention**- Students who feel unseen by institutional systems become less likely to persist.
- **Recognition-** When engagement systems focus on visible participation, non- visible students never receive the affirmation, recognition, or support they need.
- **Belonging-** Assessment systems that miss engagement medium produce data that is systematically inaccurate.
- **Equity -** The students most likely to be undercounted are first-generation, commuter, married, working, caregiving, students with disabilities, and marginalized student.

What Researchers Are Saying

Kuh (2009) NSSE	Engagement must include reflective learning, quality of interactions, and supportive environments and not just who attended.
Fritschner (2000)	Faculty equate participation with speaking aloud. Students who listen, prepare, and reflect are systematically undercounted.
Bresciani Ludvik (2019)	Student affairs assessment aligns program delivery with student learning. We measure the office, not the student.
Suskie (2018)	Assessment should begin with outcomes ('did students belong?') not activities ('did they attend?').

Theoretical Grounding

Involvement Theory Astin (1984)	Validation Theory Rendon (1994)	Sense of Belonging Strayhorn,2019	Outcome Based Assessment Suskie,2018
"The physical and psychological energy a student devotes to the college experience...."	"Institutions must proactively affirm students' strengths and ways of contributing, especially for first-gen and marginalized students."	"Belonging is a fundamental human need that shapes motivation and persistence. It fluctuates daily and varies by identity."	"Effective assessment begins with outcomes, focusing on what we want students to experience and build instruments to detect those outcomes."

Recommendation for Practice

1 Redefine Engagement as Multidimensional

- Institutions must formally expand their operational definition of student engagement beyond visible, countable participation.
- Design small-group, drop-in, virtual and one-on-one options alongside large programs.
- To address this, institutions should revise orientation programming, advising frameworks and communication materials to affirm the full scope of engagement.
- Grounded in the works of Rendón (1994)

Recommendation for Practice

2 Redesign Co-Curricular Assessment Around Student Outcomes

- Articulate desired student outcomes (such as belonging, meaningful relationships, valued contribution, campus confidence)before constructing any survey or tracking instrument.
- Replace satisfaction ratings and participation counts with pre and post-program evidence of program outcomes.
- Suskie (2018): define the outcome first, then build the instrument to detect and solve.

Recommendation for Practice

3 Train Educators to Distinguish Diverse Forms of Engagement

- Recognize engagement across cultures, personalities, and life circumstances.
- Include barrier analysis questions and open-ended prompts inviting students' opinions.

The VALID Model

A framework for equitable student engagement and assessment

V — Validate

What it does

Identify various form of engagement. Quiet, relational, digital, and reflective participation, attendance.
Affirm it explicitly in orientation, advising, and recognition.

Rendón (1994)

A — Assess

What it does

Examine barriers before drawing conclusions. Work, commuting, caregiving, disability, and cultural norms shape visibility.

Suskie (2018)

L — Listen

What it does

Let students define belonging.
Ask where they feel connected not how many events they attended.
Provide open – ended questions in surveys.

Strayhorn (2019)

I — Integrate

What it does

Combine surveys, advising records, and open responses with participation data. No single instrument captures the full picture.

Kuh (2009)

D — Design

What it does

Build programs and assessment tools around outcomes, not activities. Small groups, drop-ins, mentoring, daytime options.

Suskie (2018)

Reference

Astin, A. W. (1984). Student involvement: A developmental theory for higher education. *Journal of College Student Personnel, 25*(3), 297–308.

Bresciani Ludvik, M. J. (2019). *Outcomes-based academic and co-curricular program review* (2nd ed.). Stylus.

Fritschner, L. M. (2000). Inside the undergraduate college classroom: Faculty and students differ on the meaning of student participation. *The journal of higher education*, *71*(3), 342-362.

Kuh, G. D. (2009). The national survey of student engagement: Conceptual and empirical foundations. *New directions for institutional research*, *2009*(141), 5-20.

Mandernach, B. J. (2015). Assessment of student engagement in higher education: A synthesis of literature and assessment tools. *International Journal of Learning, Teaching and Educational Research*, *12*(2), 1-14.

Rendón, L. I. (1994). Validating culturally diverse students: Toward a new model of learning and student development. *Innovative Higher Education, 19*(1), 33–51. https://doi.org/10.1007/BF01191156

Strayhorn, T. L. (2012). *College students' sense of belonging: A key to educational success for all students.* Routledge.

Suskie, L. (2018). *Assessing student learning: A common sense guide*. John Wiley & Sons.

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